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Ignis Market Monitor: October 2026

Auctions, prices, grid, consents and capital for GB and European renewables, for CEOs and commercial and bid leads at developers and IPPs.

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Every figure is taken from a numbered public source (URL and date on the last page). Our own estimates and judgements are marked ASSUMPTION.

19 Nov	31 Oct	£145/MWh	+10.9%
AR8 budget notice and Notice of Auction	Gate 2 Phase 1 offers deadline (about 62 offers)	GB spot average, 1–17 Oct 2026 (Oct 2025: £73)	GB PPA index, September (Pexapark)

Three things a CEO should act on this month

1. Get your AR8 strike-price floor and your CfD-or-PPA call signed off before 19 November.

DESNZ publishes the AR8 Contract Budget Notice and NESO the Notice of Auction on **19 November 2026**. Sealed bids follow in early December, and results are expected **15–17 February 2027** [1] [2]. In AR7 every main pot cleared 13–21% below the AR8 price caps (ASPs): solar at £65.23 against £75, onshore wind at £72.24 against £92 (2024 prices) [3] [5]. Government will have sight of bids in Pots 1–4 [3]. Meanwhile GB short-term power has averaged **£145/MWh so far in October**, double October 2025 [27], and Pexapark's GB PPA index rose 10.9% in September [28]. ASSUMPTION higher forward prices make the PPA or merchant route more competitive with a CfD, so the comparison has to be re-run on current curves. Leaving it until budget day would be a mistake.

Act: get investment committee approval for a single walk-away sealed bid by mid-November. Pot 1·4 bids are visible to Government and cannot use flexible bids (AR8 Allocation Framework Rule 13.3). Only Pot 5 projects may submit up to four flexible-bid variants (Rule 13.7) [4].

2. Treat every Gate 2 offer as a board decision with a deadline.

NESO must issue the remaining Gate 2 Phase 1 offers (about 62) by **31 October 2026** after a second extension. Phase 2 follows by 31 January 2027 [6]. Acceptance windows are already closing. On National Grid Electricity Distribution's published schedule, the next batches close on **26 Oct, 2 Nov, 9 Nov, 16 Nov and 23 Nov** (Batch 4 closed on 19 Oct) [8]. Only 20.8 GW of the 604 GW not-yet-built transmission queue has a countersigned Gate 2 label so far (Figure 5) [10].

Act: review each offer's date, securities and works against its route to market (CfD round, Capacity Market, cap and floor, PPA), then decide whether to accept, challenge or drop it before its window closes.

3. Have your contracted-revenue structure ready before you go to capital.

October's GB flexibility deals were built on contracted or optimised revenue. CIP took FID on the 350 MW / 1.4 GWh Kilmarnock South battery, which has a long-term Shell optimisation agreement [41]. Econergy's Dalmarnock battery has a 10-year EDF floor and Santander debt [43]. Ares bought into Statera's 1.9 GW portfolio [39]. Across Europe in September, 16 flexibility agreements covered about 2.1 GW, including 925 MW of tolls [28]. ASSUMPTION lenders and equity are pricing BESS on the quality of its floor or toll as much as on the project itself.

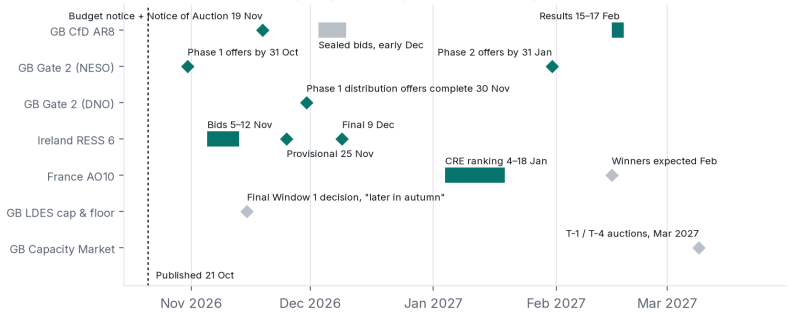
Act: run a toll and floor process in parallel with financing, not after it.

1. Auction and tender calendar and results

FIGURE 1

Decision calendar, October 2026 to March 2027

Teal = fixed date in an official or primary source. Grey = month or season only (indicative).



Sources: DESNZ via Energy Voice and New Energy Weekly (15 Oct 2026); Ofgem G2tWQ letter (2 Oct 2026); EirGrid RESS 6 timetable rev 1.3 (6 Oct 2026); CRE AO10 specification via Pilotable (13 Oct 2026); Ofgem LDES Window 1 consultation; DESNZ Capacity Market parameters letter (Jul 2026).

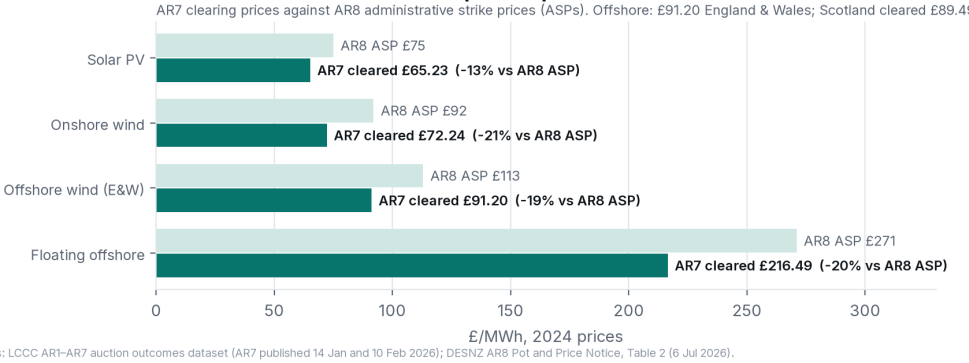
ROUND	STATUS AT 18 OCT 2026	NEXT MILESTONE	SOURCE
GB CfD AR8	On the longest indicative timetable because qualification appeals run first; the pending-applications route is not being used	Budget notice and Notice of Auction **19 Nov 2026**; sealed bids early Dec; results **15–17 Feb 2027**	1 2
GB CfD AR7 / AR7a (results)	Offshore wind 8,245 MW at £91.20 (England and Wales) and £89.49 (Scotland); floating 192.5 MW at £216.49 (published 14 Jan 2026). Solar 4,905 MW at £65.23; onshore wind 1,306 MW at £72.24; tidal 20.9 MW at £265 (10 Feb 2026). All in 2024 prices	n/a	5 Ignis sum of project rows
France AO10 offshore (≈10 GW, 11 projects)	Bids closed at noon on 12 Oct 2026. CRE has 12 weeks to rank the offers (to 4 Jan 2027, 18 Jan at the latest); bidder names are not public	Winners expected **Feb 2027**; the guaranteed tariff must average below €100/MWh across the 11 projects	12 13 14 15
France PPE2 ground-mounted PV, period 9	125 winners, 931.4 MWc, weighted average **€61.33/MWh**, down 23% on period 8 (€79.48). 731 bids for 5,358.7 MWc, 5.8 times the 925 MWc sought	First period with the EU Net-Zero Industry Act (NZIA) resilience criterion	16
France PPE2 onshore wind	Period 11: 39 projects, 808.02 MW at **€77.08/MWh** (7 Jul 2026). Period 13 (1 GW) specification published 7 Oct, with the NZIA resilience criterion	CRE warns NZIA turbine availability could push bid prices up	17 18
Ireland RESS 6 (onshore wind, solar)	Qualification in progress	Final qualification **28 Oct**; bids **5–12 Nov**; provisional results **25 Nov**; final results **9 Dec 2026**; award notices 11 Jan 2027	19
Ireland ORESS	Tonn Nua (900 MW) awarded at €98.719/MWh, final results 9 Dec 2025. Next round is Area B, "Lí Ban"	No auction date published	20
GB LDES cap and floor, Window 1	Minded-to decision provisionally selects 16 projects (7,645 MW, 136.9 GWh). Consultation closed 14 Aug	Final decision "later in autumn 2026"; statutory licence consultation expected Q1 2027	24 25 47
GB Capacity Market	Prequalification 2026 covers T-1 2027/28 (target 5.0 GW) and T-4 2030/31 (target 40.9 GW)	Auctions planned for **March 2027**	26
Spain	A capacity market was created by Orden TED/966/2026 (15 Sep 2026); new investment is limited to renewables, storage and demand. The first offshore wind tender has no date	Auction calendar not yet published	21 22 23

2. Price signals

FIGURE 2

AR7 cleared well below the AR8 price caps

AR7 clearing prices against AR8 administrative strike prices (ASPs). Offshore: £91.20 England & Wales; Scotland cleared £89.49.



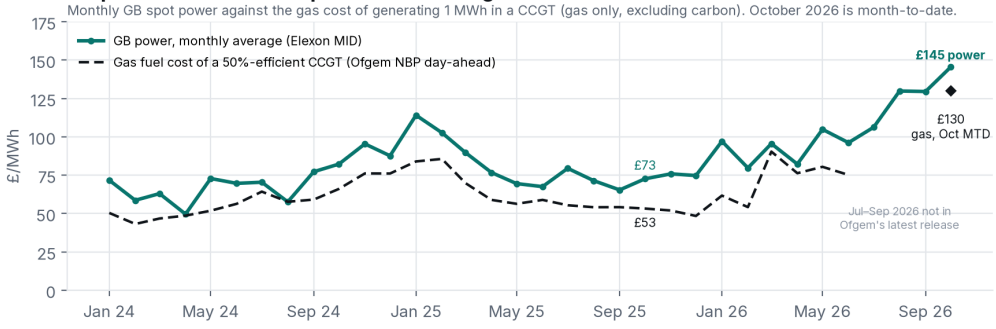
Sources: LCCC AR1–AR7 auction outcomes dataset (AR7 published 14 Jan and 10 Feb 2026); DESNZ AR8 Pot and Price Notice, Table 2 (6 Jul 2026).

CfD. The AR8 administrative strike prices, in 2024 prices, are solar £75, onshore wind £92, offshore wind £113, floating offshore £271 and tidal stream £371/MWh [3]. AR7 cleared 13% (solar), 21% (onshore), 19% (offshore, England and Wales) and 20% (floating) below those caps (Ignis calculation from [3] [5]). AR8 adds government visibility of floating and deepwater offshore bids, so bid visibility now covers Pots 1–4 [3].

FIGURE 3

GB power has risen in step with the cost of gas

Monthly GB spot power against the gas cost of generating 1 MWh in a CCGT (gas only, excluding carbon). October 2026 is month-to-date.



Sources: Elexon MID (APXMIDP), to 17 Oct 2026; Ofgem Wholesale Market Indicators, NBP day-ahead monthly average, to Jun 2026; Purely Energy, NBP day-ahead month-to-date average to 16 Oct 2026. Ignis calculation: p/therm × 10 ÷ 29.3071 ÷ 0.5. The 50% efficiency is Ofgem's central spark-spread assumption.

Wholesale (GB). Elexon's Market Index Data (APX), averaged by month, was **£145.49/MWh for 1–17 October 2026**, against £129.56 in September 2026 and £72.59 in October 2025 [27] (Ignis calculation). No half-hour has priced below zero so far this October, against 29 in October 2025 [27]. These are short-term spot prices, not forwards.

What is driving GB power prices up

Gas sets the price, and gas has nearly tripled. Gas-fired plant still sets the marginal GB power price for much of the time [51] [52]. NBP gas was about **217p/therm on 18 October, up 168% on a year earlier** [49]. Nov-26 closed at 216.83p on 13 October, up 15% in a week on colder forecasts [50]. At Ofgem's 50% CCGT efficiency [59], October's gas cost per MWh is about **£130, against £53 a year ago**: roughly the whole +£73 rise in spot power (Figure 3; Ignis calculation from [27] [58] [59]).

The trigger is the Iran conflict and the Strait of Hormuz.

- Day-ahead NBP jumped from £26.7 to £47.0/MWh on 1–3 March as the conflict escalated [51].
- In Q2, the US–Israel–Iran conflict and Hormuz disruption drew LNG cargoes away from the UK [52].
- In July, US–Iran exchanges lifted day-ahead NBP 34% in a month [53]. Reuters (19 August) reported the "Iran war" pushing the October price cap to a three-year high [54] [55].
- Stalled peace talks kept prices rising in September [56]. In the week to 13 October, shipping attacks, Norwegian outages and Asian LNG at $29.61/MMBtu added more [50].

Low storage amplifies the shock. At the end of July, EU storage was 57.7% full and UK storage 27% [53]. By 12 October Europe was about 73.75% full, over nine points below last year [50]. With little storage of its own, the UK tracks the continental fill [58].

Wind and weather drive the swings. Day-ahead power rose from £130 to £160/MWh over September, largely on a sharp fall in wind into October [56]. Strong wind took next-day power to £33.89 on 9 October [50]. Demand spikes came from a January

cold spell [51] and summer heatwaves that raised gas burn for power [52] [55]; forecasts now show temperatures up to 3.8°C below normal [50].

Carbon is minor. UK ETS allowances were £58.26/t at the end of July [53] and £65.92/t on 13 October, on UK–EU linking reports [50]. The 2026 reference price is £49.41/t [57]. ASSUMPTION at about 0.37 tCO_2 per MWh for a CCGT, that adds roughly £3–6/MWh against about £77 from gas.

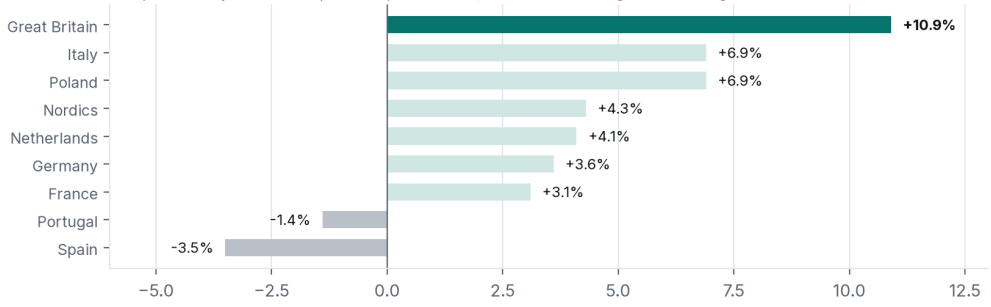
Nuclear and interconnectors: not established. Q2 nuclear output fell 12% year on year and NESO capped some interconnector trades from May [52], but no public source ties October's rise to an outage.

Forwards price the premium into 2027, not beyond. On 16 October, Summer-27 power settled at **£127.36/MWh** and NBP Summer-27 at 164.30p/therm. Summer-28 power was £80.69 and Summer-29 £72.80 [58]. Summer-27 power was £83.00 at the end of July [53] and £104.75 at the end of September [56]. Caveat: most figures here are from broker and consultancy notes, not exchange data.

What it means for developers. ASSUMPTION this is our judgement, not a forecast.

- **CfD against PPA or merchant.** The premium sits in the next 12–18 months. By Summer-28 and Summer-29 the curve (£73–81, nominal) is back below the onshore wind ASP of £92 and near AR7's £72.24 (both in 2024 prices) [3] [5] [58]. Projects that can generate before 2028 can capture today's prices through a short PPA or merchant phase. AR8 projects delivering later mostly cannot, so the CfD stays the bankable floor.
- **BESS.** Imbalance prices ran from −£13.30 to £254/MWh within three days in October [50]. Gas-set peaks and wind-set troughs widen spreads, which supports merchant revenue. Tolls and floors signed now may be priced off this unusual volatility, so test them against a calmer 2028 curve.
- **Cost of delay.** A 50 MW onshore wind farm at a 30% load factor produces about 11 GWh a month. Each month late forgoes about £1.4m at the Summer-27 forward, but only about £0.8m at Summer-29. Delay is most expensive now.

FIGURE 4
GB led Europe on PPA price moves in September
Pexapark country indices. European composite +5.0%; GB was also the largest riser in August (+4.9%).



Source: Pexapark via pv magazine, "European PPA prices rise 5% in September" (13 Oct 2026) and "PPA prices rise 2.2% in Europe in August" (15 Sep 2026).

PPAs.

- Pexapark's GB PPA index rose **10.9%** month on month in September, the largest rise in Europe (European composite +5%). Spain (−3.5%) and Portugal (−1.4%) fell [28].
- In August, GB rose 4.9% after Pexapark revised its market-price-risk assessment: about **+£5/MWh** for a 10-year PPA at comparable start dates [29].
- LevelTen's Europe-wide solar P25 rose 2.8% in Q2 2026, ending four quarters of decline; wind fell 1.6% [31].
- LevelTen's latest public UK figure is a solar P25 of **€87.36/MWh** for Q4 2025 [30]. Its Q3 2026 European index is due on **22 October** [32].
- ASSUMPTION a CfD bid floor modelled against last spring's curves is now out of date.

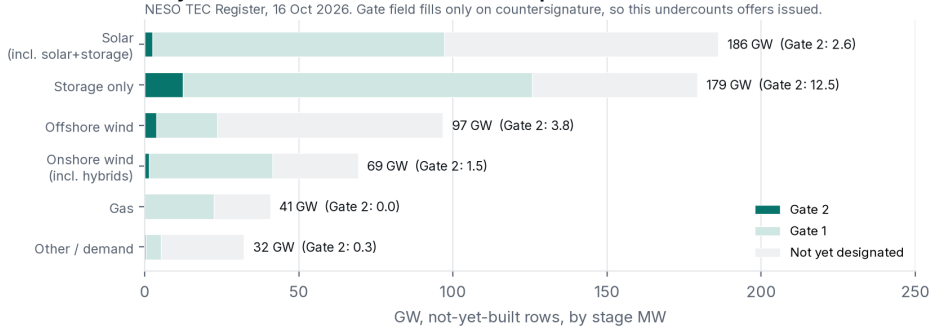
3. Grid: connections reform and the queue

This month.

- On 2 October, Ofgem agreed NESO's second extension for Gate 2 Phase 1 offers to **31 October 2026**. It affects about 62 offers, delayed mainly by NGET transmission owner construction offers (TOCOs), plus about 25 delayed at customer request [6].
- Phase 2 offers are due by 31 January 2027. Distribution offers should be complete by 30 November 2026 (Phase 1) and 31 March 2027 (Phase 2) [6].
- By 10 June, NESO and the DNOs had issued updated offers to 713 projects, about 37 GW [9]. NESO releases offers location by location [7].

- National Grid Electricity Distribution has split its Batch 10. Batches 10 and 11 now expect offers on **20 and 27 November**, with acceptance by 28 December and 4 January [8].

FIGURE 5
Only 20.8 GW of a 604 GW transmission queue carries a Gate 2 label
NESO TEC Register, 16 Oct 2026. Gate field fills only on countersignature, so this undercounts offers issued.



Source: NESO TEC Register, 16 Oct 2026 (CSV); Ignis calculation: rows not marked Built, summed MW Increase/Decrease; hybrids classed by first renewable technology.

Queue size (NESO TEC Register, 16 Oct 2026) [10], Ignis calculation:

- **Register level:** 690.0 GW (MW connected plus MW increase/decrease, all rows).
- **Not-yet-built queue:** 604 GW. Of this, Gate 1 is 295.0 GW, Gate 2 is 20.8 GW (124 projects) and 288.3 GW is not yet designated.
- **By technology:** storage-only projects are 179 GW and solar, including solar plus storage, is 186 GW.
- **Change:** a public tracker using the same basis puts the register at 684.3 GW on 25 Aug and 691.3 GW on 13 Oct. Most of the rise came from 29 projects (11.1 GW, mostly storage) joining on 13 Oct, 25 of them already holding a Gate 1 label [11].
- **Connection years:** queue capacity peaks at 83.1 GW in 2033 and 95.1 GW in 2037, by the year in MW Effective From [10].
- **Caveat:** the Gate field fills only when an agreement is countersigned, so it undercounts offers issued [11].

4. Consents

DATE (2026)	PROJECT	DECISION	SOURCE
8 Oct	**Green Hill Solar Farm** (Northamptonshire and Milton Keynes), up to 500 MW solar with storage	DCO **granted**	33
9 Oct	**Steeple Renewables Project** (Nottinghamshire, RES), about 450 MW solar and about 150 MW BESS	DCO **granted**; 115th of 183 energy applications examined to date	34
5 Oct / 7 Oct	Five Estuaries offshore wind (correction of errors); LionLink multi-purpose interconnector (s35 direction varied)	Procedural decisions	38
15 Oct	Vattenfall's **Chatteris** (up to 15 turbines) and **Redmere** (up to 32 turbines) onshore wind, Cambridgeshire	East Cambridgeshire District Council voted to **oppose** both. The council is not the decision-maker	36
Due 10 Nov	**Botley West Solar Farm**, Oxfordshire (840 MW)	Decision deadline extended from 10 Sep	37

ASSUMPTION large solar DCOs are being granted. The risk now sits in local opposition and decision-deadline slippage (Botley West has been extended once), not in outright refusal. We found no October refusal of a GB energy DCO. For context, the Morgan and Morecambe offshore transmission assets DCO was granted on 14 September [35]. Not covered: we did not systematically review October decisions under the Town and Country Planning Act (TCPA) or Scottish Section 36 (S36).

5. Deals and capital (October 2026)

DATE	DEAL	DETAIL	SOURCE
2 Oct	**CIP: FID on Kilmarnock South BESS** (South Ayrshire)	350 MW / 1,400 MWh; more than €270m committed; COD Q1 2028; long-term Shell optimisation agreement	41
13 Oct	**CIP buys 25% of Five Estuaries** offshore wind	Up to 1,080 MW, from the Macquarie-led consortium; EDF power solutions 33.33%, ESB and Sumitomo 20.83% each	40

DATE	DEAL	DETAIL	SOURCE
14 Oct	**Ares takes a minority stake in Statera's 1.9 GW portfolio**	Includes Carrington Storage (680 MW) and Thurrock Flexible Generation (750 MW); Ares Infrastructure Equity's first European investment; terms not disclosed	39
14 Oct	**ORIT conditionally acquires Barnsdale Solar Park** (West Yorkshire)	55 MWp, AR5 CfD to 2041; about £34.6m including remaining construction costs (about £0.63m/MWp, Ignis calculation)	44
15 Oct	**Greencoat UK Wind buys EDF Invest's 20%** of a 96.4 MW onshore portfolio	Takes it to 100%; joint repowering arrangement with EDF	42
Oct	**Econergy's Dalmarnock BESS** connects	40 MW / 120 MWh; about £21m Santander project finance; 10-year EDF floor with revenue share	43
10 Oct	Ireland: **Elgin acquires Kilderry Solar** from BayWa r.e.	40 MWp, County Kilkenny	45
9 Oct	Spain: **Dos Grados acquires more than 500 MW of solar development** from Akuo	Castilla y León and Andalusia	45

Late September, for context: Revera reached financial close on the 400 MW / 800 MWh Hunterston BESS with a BP toll and a Danske Commodities floor (25 Sep) 46.

6. What we're watching next month

- **22 Oct:** LevelTen's Q3 2026 European PPA index 32.
- **28 Oct:** RESS 6 final qualification decisions 19.
- **31 Oct:** Gate 2 Phase 1 offers deadline 6.
- **5–12 Nov:** RESS 6 bid window 19.
- **10 Nov:** Botley West decision deadline 37.
- **19 Nov:** AR8 budget notice and Notice of Auction 1 2.
- **20 Nov:** EU–UK summit, with UK–EU carbon market linking on the table; a link would move UK ETS prices 50.
- **25 Nov:** RESS 6 provisional results 19.
- **30 Nov:** Gate 2 Phase 1 distribution offers complete 6.
- **Ofgem LDES Window 1 final decision**, expected "later in autumn" 24.
- **Pexapark's October PPA index**, due mid-November (ASSUMPTION based on its usual monthly cadence).
- **The question for November:** does the AR8 budget, read against £130–145 spot prices, make PPA or merchant the better route for marginal solar and onshore wind? We will run that comparison when the budget is published.

Method and data notes

- **Wholesale:** simple average of half-hourly APXMIDP prices with non-zero volume, from Elexon's API, 1 Jan 2024 to 17 Oct 2026. October 2026 is month-to-date. Full series in `data/`.
- **TEC Register:** rows not marked Built, summed "MW Increase / Decrease". Hybrid sites are classed by their first renewable technology. Third-party trackers using other conventions report different Gate 2 totals, for example 15.4 GW countersigned on 16 Oct 48 and 19.2 GW on 13 Oct 11.
- **Gas cost of power (Figure 3):** NBP p/therm × 10 ÷ 29.3071 = £/MWh of gas; ÷ 0.5 for a 50%-efficient CCGT (Ofgem's central spark-spread assumption). Gas only, excluding carbon. October 2026 uses Purely Energy's day-ahead month-to-date average to 16 Oct; Ofgem's monthly series ends in June 2026. Carbon effect: ASSUMPTION of about 0.37 tCO_2/MWh for a CCGT, applied to the UK ETS rise above the 2026 reference price.
- **UK gas storage:** mid-October public figures disagree (about 62% per Catalyst on 13 Oct 50; 42.4% per Purely Energy on 15 Oct 58), so we quote only the end-July figure.
- **CfD prices:** AR7 and AR8 are in 2024 prices. Earlier rounds are in 2012 prices and are not comparable.
- **Not verified:**
- Exact AR8 sealed-bid window dates (secondary reports say early December; NESO confirms them on 19 Nov).
- The Gate 2 Phase 1 capacity still to be issued.
- GB-specific LevelTen P25 levels for Q1–Q3 2026.
- Spain's offshore auction date.
- Any October refusal of a GB onshore project under TCPA or S36.
- Any specific nuclear or interconnector outage behind October's price rise.

- The Reuters article [54] is paywalled; its 'Iran war' wording is confirmed via its syndicated text and Cornwall Insight's own release [55].

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